

Groups on Russia Progress Report

Rafael Campos-Gottardo & Alan Nemirovski

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Comments from meeting: Feb. 12, 2026

- Pro-Russia/Pro-Ukraine dichotomy in the long-run as opposed to doing the more granular “Russia appeaser” (only using dichotomous question around trade/security, i.e., Q73) → appeaser group is conceptually too small over time
- “Other” group is too big
- Appeasers: also more broad appeasers (potentially on a more general note) → sticking with smaller appeasers group for short
- Additional data sources: European Social Survey, European Values Survey (same as World Values Survey), Eurobarometer survey (look at those for additional Russia-related Q’s?)
- Calling people that selected “Neither” or “Don’t Know” as “Un-knowledgeable” (more broadly)

Long-term (simplified) measure

Long-term measure centered on dichotomous question for trade with Russia (Pro-Russia) or defence against Russia (Pro-Ukraine); all outstanding respondents tentatively classed as “Other”.

```
EUI_data <- EUI_data %>%
  mutate(ukrainegroups_long = case_when(
    #classed as Pro-Russia
    Q73 == "European countries should invest more in trade and diplomacy with Russia to improve relations" ~ "Pro-Russia",
    #classed as Pro-Ukraine
    Q73 == "European countries should invest more in defence and security to defend against Russian aggression" ~ "Pro-Ukraine",
    TRUE ~ "Other"))

table(EUI_data$ukrainegroups_long)
```

```
##
##      Other  Pro-Russia Pro-Ukraine
##      53948      51603      57573
```

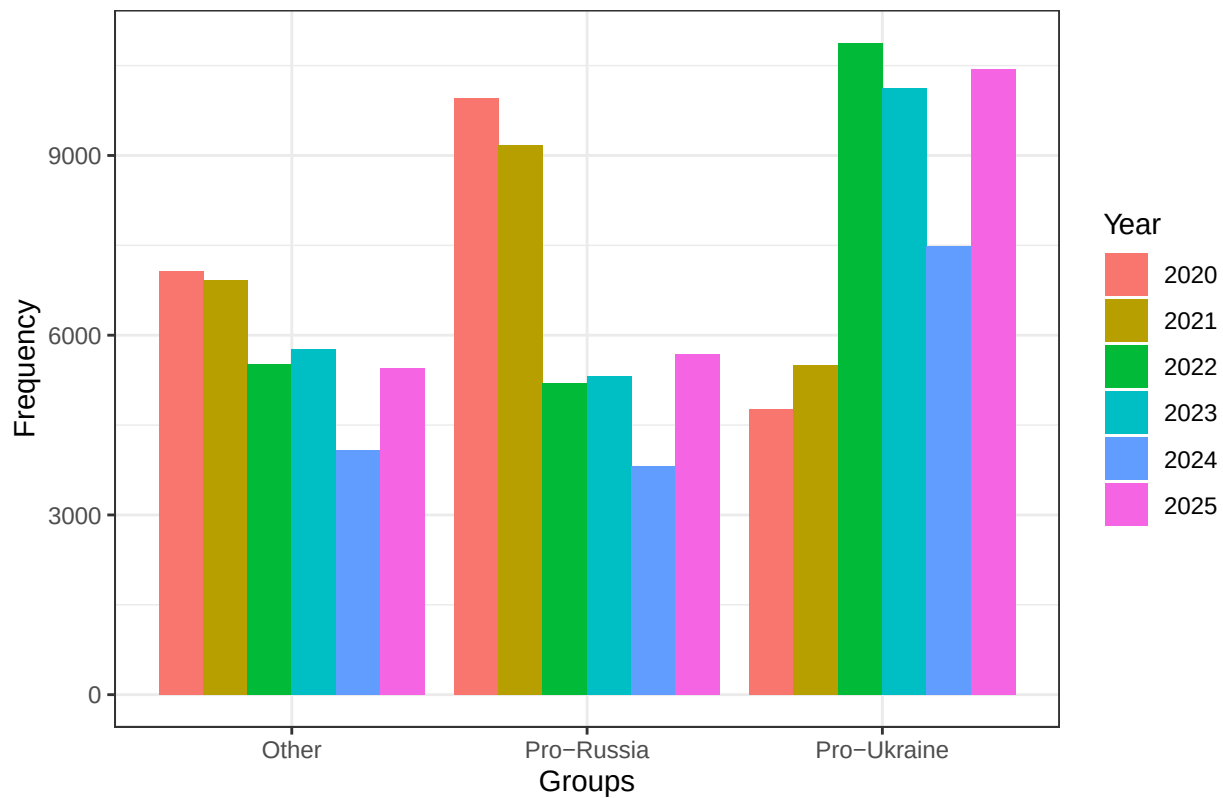
Trends over time: Long-term measure

```
COUNTRIES_2020 <- c("Denmark", "Finland", "France", "Germany", "Greece", "Hungary", "Italy", "Lithuania", "Poland", "Portugal", "Romania", "Slovakia", "Slovenia", "Spain", "Sweden", "Switzerland", "Ukraine")

#Frequencies
EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2019) %>%
  filter(country %in% COUNTRIES_2020) %>%
  ggplot(aes(x = ukrainegroups_long, fill = as.factor(Year), group = as.factor(Year))) +
  geom_bar(position = "dodge") +
  labs(fill = "Year", title = "Russia Attitudinal Groups: Simplified Long-Term Measure",
```

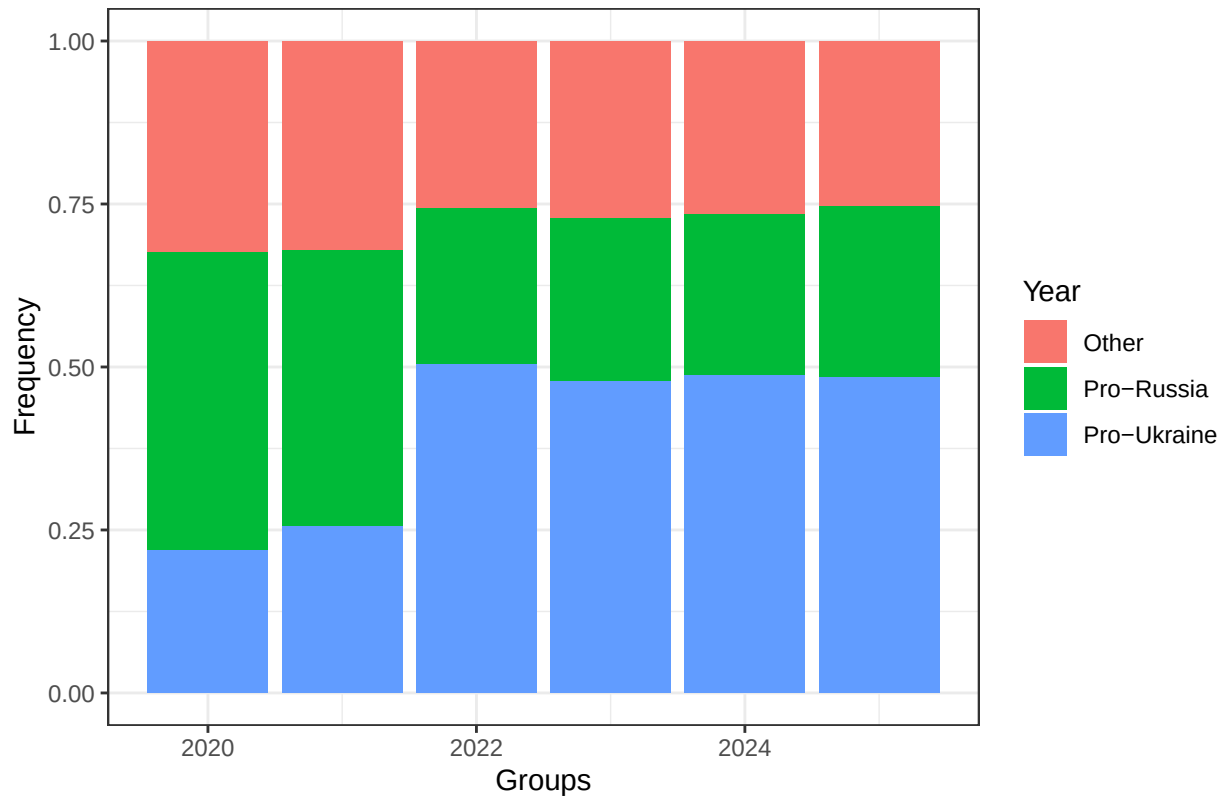
```
x = "Groups", y = "Frequency") +  
theme_bw()
```

Russia Attitudinal Groups: Simplified Long-Term Measure



```
#Proportions  
EUI_data %>%  
  filter(Year > 2019) %>%  
  filter(country %in% COUNTRIES_2020) %>%  
  ggplot(aes(x = Year, fill = as.factor(ukrainegroups_long))) +  
  geom_bar(position = "fill") +  
  labs(fill = "Year", title = "Russia Attitudinal Group Proportions: Simplified Long-Term Measure",  
        x = "Groups", y = "Frequency") +  
  theme_bw()
```

Russia Attitudinal Group Proportions: Simplified Long-Term Measure



Short-term (simplified) measure

```
#creating "short" dataset for separate short-term variable manipulation
EUI_data_short <- EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2022) %>%
  #creating counts for "proukr", "prorus", and "dk" ("don't know") camps
  mutate(Q73_proukr = as.integer(Q73 == "European countries should invest more in defence and security"),
         Q73_prorus = as.integer(Q73 == "European countries should invest more in trade and diplomacy w..."),
         Q73_dk = as.integer(Q73 == "Neither/DK"),

         Q78_4_prorus = as.integer(New_Q78_4 %in% c(3, 4)),
         Q78_4_proukr = as.integer(New_Q78_4 %in% c(1, 2)),
         Q78_4_dk = as.integer(New_Q78_4 == 5),

         Q78_5_prorus = as.integer(New_Q78_5 %in% c(3, 4)),
         Q78_5_proukr = as.integer(New_Q78_5 %in% c(1, 2)),
         Q78_5_dk = as.integer(New_Q78_5 == 5),

         #summing responses in each direction per individual
         prorus_count = Q73_prorus + Q78_4_prorus + Q78_5_prorus,
         proukr_count = Q73_proukr + Q78_4_proukr + Q78_5_proukr,
         dk_count = Q73_dk + Q78_4_dk + Q78_5_dk,

         ukrainegroups_short = case_when(
           #at least 2/3 pro-Russia answers
```

```

prorus_count >= 2 ~ "Pro-Russia",
#at least 2/3 pro-Ukraine answers
proukr_count >=2 ~ "Pro-Ukraine",
#exactly 1/3 pro-Russia AND 1/3 pro-Ukraine answer
prorus_count == 1 & proukr_count == 1 ~ "Ambivalent",
#at least 2/3 "Don't Know's"
dk_count >= 2 ~ "Unknowledgeable",
TRUE ~ "Other")) #"Other" included as a fail-safe category

#Every individual was classed into one of four categories
#(we can see this because there is no "Other" category in the table)
table(EUI_data_short$ukrainegroups_short)

```

```

##
##      Ambivalent      Pro-Russia      Pro-Ukraine Unknowledgeable
##      11409          12125          32331          17620

```

Trends over time: Short-term measure

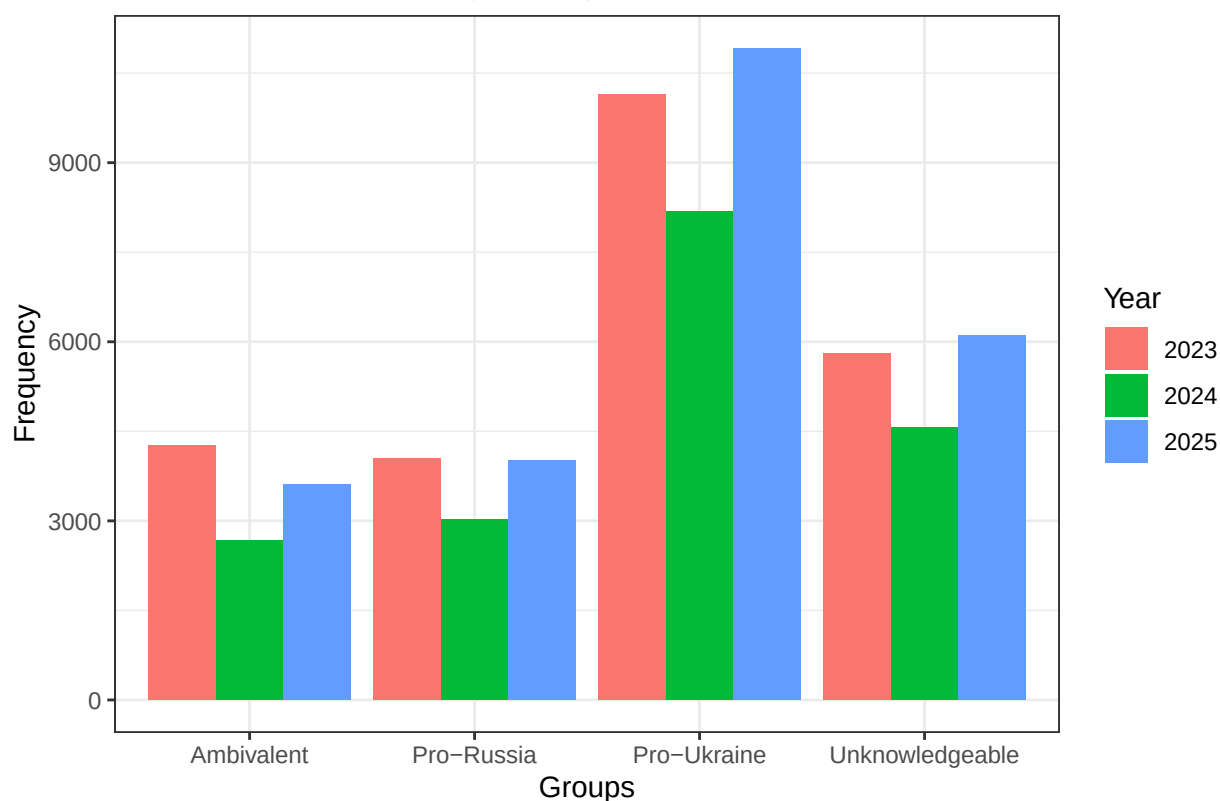
```

COUNTRIES_2023 <- c("UK", "Denmark", "Greece", "Hungary", "Lithuania", "Italy", "Poland", "Netherlands")

#Frequencies
EUI_data_short %>%
  filter(Year > 2022) %>%
  filter(country %in% COUNTRIES_2023) %>%
  ggplot(aes(x = ukrainegroups_short, fill = as.factor(Year), group = as.factor(Year))) +
  geom_bar(position = "dodge") +
  labs(fill = "Year", title = "Russia Attitudinal Groups: Simplified Short-Term Measure",
       x = "Groups", y = "Frequency") +
  theme_bw()

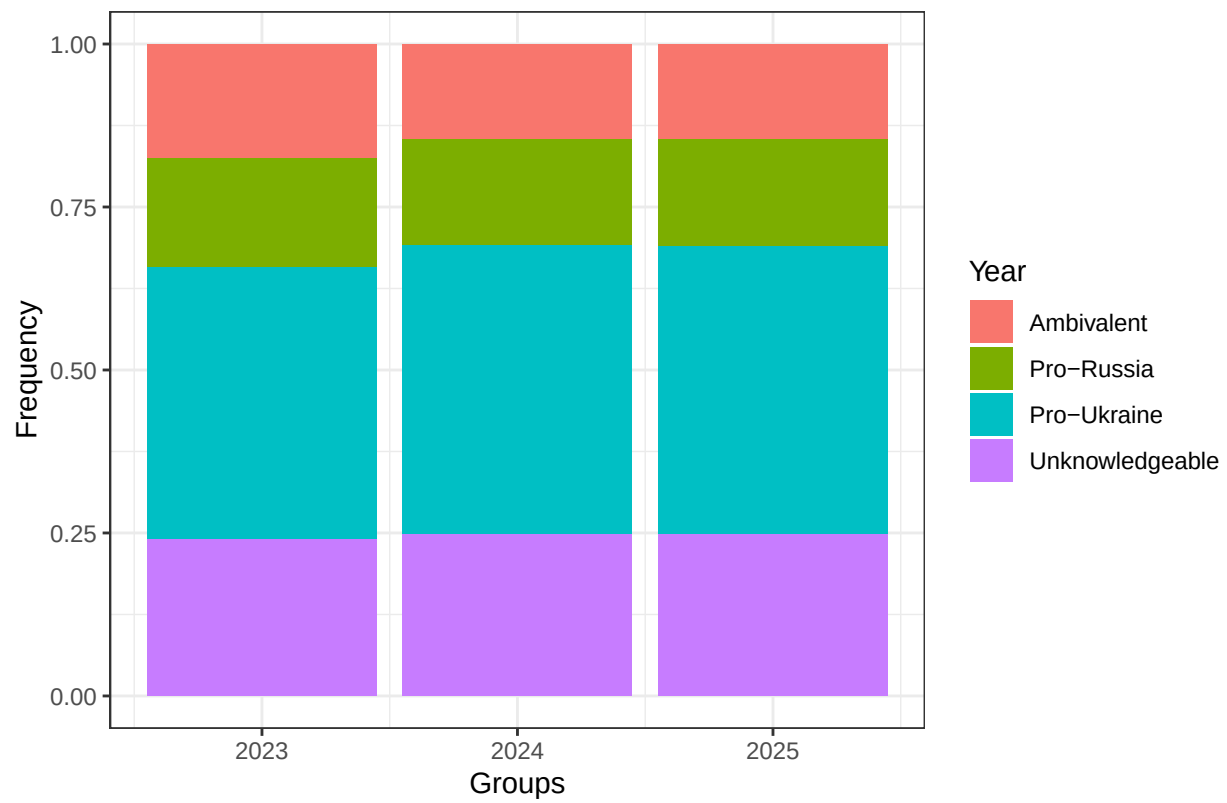
```

Russia Attitudinal Groups: Simplified Short-Term Measure



```
#Proportions
EUI_data_short %>%
  filter(Year > 2022) %>%
  filter(country %in% COUNTRIES_2023) %>%
  ggplot(aes(x = Year, fill = as.factor(ukrainegroups_short))) +
  geom_bar(position = "fill") + #for frequency, change position to "dodge"
  labs(fill = "Year", title = "Russia Attitudinal Group Proportions: Simplified Short-Term Measure",
        x = "Groups", y = "Frequency") +
  theme_bw()
```

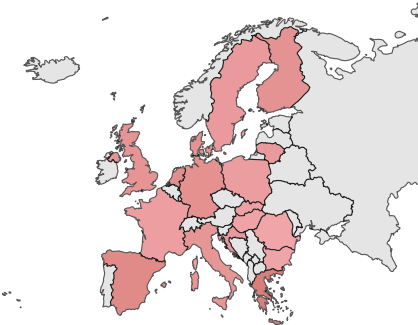
Russia Attitudinal Group Proportions: Simplified Short-Term Measure



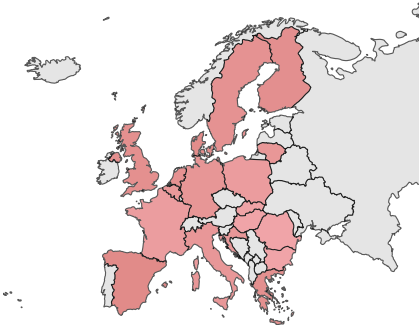
Country-level trends along new short-term measure

Pro-Russia

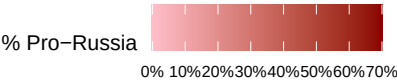
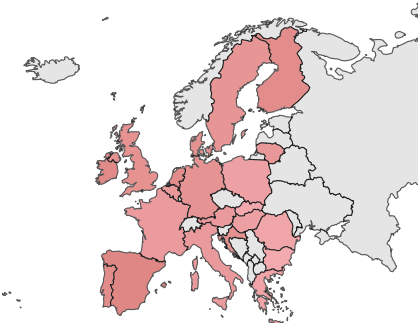
2023



2024

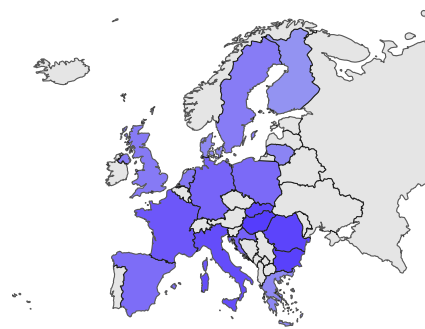


2025

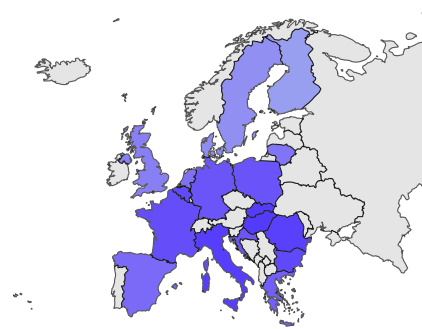


Pro-Ukraine

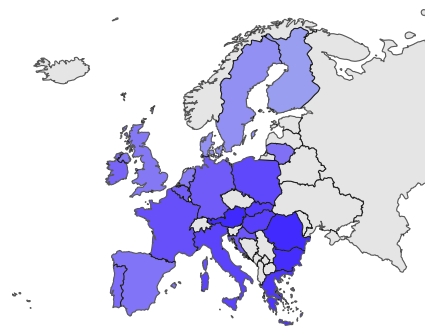
2023



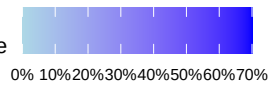
2024



2025



% Pro-Ukraine



Ambivalent

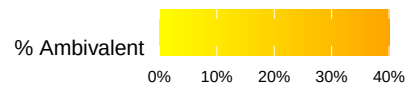
2023



2024

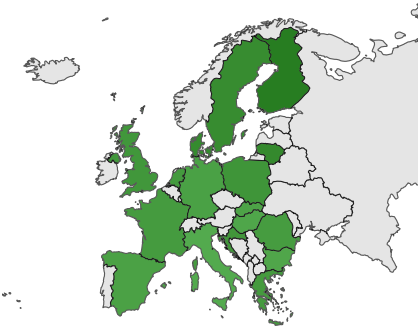


2025

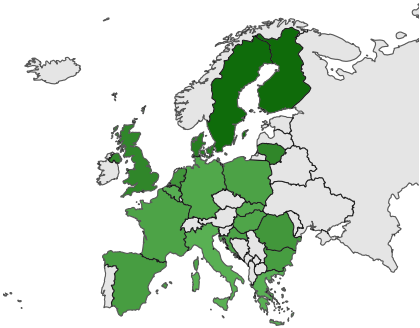


Unknowledgeable

2023



2024



2025

